Changelog — ABCC 2027 Preparation (HSBI)

ABCC 2027 preparation · Repository root

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All notable changes to the preparation material. Dates are the dates of the work, not of any release. Versions are work packages, not semantic versions.

Until v9 the material lived in two layers — a flat working directory plus `asper-abcc-2027.zip`, which held the eight-folder structure as a nested git repository. v9 flattened them into the single repository this file sits in. The two histories are listed separately below; the pre-v9 archive commits are preserved on the **`archive-history`** branch.

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v12 — Handouts, and scope narrowed to the competition · 2026-08-16

Added — every document also published in the format it is used in

- **37 PDFs**, one per markdown document, **built beside its source** (`handbook.md` → `handbook.pdf`), the pairing `08-briefing-slides/` already used: house style (XCharter/Source Sans, deep-blue headings, running head, print footer), a generated table of contents where a document lacks its own, and cross-links re-pointed so the PDFs link to each other exactly as the markdown does.
- **Four PowerPoint decks** for the documents that exist to be *presented* rather than read — `coach_and_ai_rules` (15 slides), `frameworks` (21), `presentation_and_storyline_guide` (36), `case_type_playbook` (34). These are condensed rewrites; the slide sources live in `tools/slides/`.
- **`tools/`** — `build_handouts.py`, `build_decks.py`, `check_decks.py`, the shared LaTeX preamble, `slides/make_reference.py` (which patches pandoc's reference `.pptx` into the house style), and a `README.md` explaining the build. The PDFs and decks are build output; the markdown remains the source of truth and is the only thing edited by hand.

Fixed — a rendering bug in the source material

- Currency written as `CA$…` was being parsed as LaTeX maths wherever two dollar signs met on one line, swallowing whole phrases into a maths font. It affected `mini_cases.md`, `model_answers.md`, the quant workbooks and others. Fixed in the build (`-tex_math_dollars`); the markdown itself was correct.

Removed — travel, visas and accommodation

The material now covers the competition only. `07-logistics/travel_logistics.md` deleted, and every flight, eTA, passport, hotel, insurance, winter-gear and airport-transfer reference stripped from `README.md`, `DOCUMENTATION.md`, `01-competition/{facts_and_rules,handbook,past_cases}.md`, `02-plan/{week_by_week_plan,preparation_plan}.md`, `03-team/role_playbooks.md`, `04-training/{presentation_and_storyline_guide,exercises/format_quiz}.md`, all of `07-logistics/`, and the kick-off Beamer deck (its "Travel and Administration" subsection is gone; the deck is now **24 pages**). The competition-day runbook keeps its operating script; the registration e-mail keeps four open questions instead of seven — the hotel-block and letter-of-invitation asks are gone.

Counts after this change: 61 files, 41 markdown documents, ≈81,000 words.

Re-verified against the official sources (2026-08-16)

Checked against the case-competitions page, the 2027 competition page, the **2025 Event Guide** and the official 2025 boardroom case PDF. Everything held: the three round formats and their 25/30/45 weights, all seven rubric categories and multipliers, the GenAI and internet clause verbatim, the anonymity and coach-contact rules, the A–I division draw, the nine-team field, the final-round mechanics, the contacts, and the one-page **black-and-white** judge brief that judges get **10 minutes** before the team enters — that last detail comes from the case PDF, not the Event Guide. Two dates were tightened: 2026 ran **Wed Feb 18 – Sat Feb 21** (UM Today), and ABCC 2024 ran **Feb 21–24**, also a Wednesday start — so the "three Wednesday starts in a row" claim behind the 2027 weekday question is now sourced for all three editions.

v11 — Second content audit · 2026-08-05

The remaining half of the material — the documents no prior pass had read end to end — audited, with the quantitative teaching apparatus recomputed in full.

Verified clean (nothing changed)

- **`model_answers.md`:** the Access CU model economics recompute exactly — the $8.0M program (4.5 + 1.75 + 1.75 by year; 0.8 + 1.7 + 2.75 + 2.75 by phase), ~$670 all-in per acquired member, and the +12,000 target's share arithmetic on both the 15% and 11% youth-base assumptions. The AROW brief's gates sum to its Year-1 investment (0.6 + 1.6 + 2.0 = 4.2) and Gate 1 is ≈15% of spend, matching the "before 85% of spend" claim.
- **Case 1's teaching note is calibrated to its own exhibits:** the CLV path reproduces to ≈€1,420 (stated band €1,100–1,500); the guardrail trap, redesigned package, cliff and funnel yields, value-at-stake, funding exposure, and CIR bridge all recompute from case data.
- **Every hook in workbook 4's number-attack gauntlet exists in the case it targets** — the €5,000 cap, the €7.5m package, the 6,000–8,000 breakeven, the 78% parent-opened share, Klangfest's €330k floor, the Westkrone and Innovationsfonds dates. Workbook 1's answer keys match the real-case facts in the dossier.
- The phrasebook's language guidance (stress patterns, -ed endings, number conventions, Milliarde/billion) is accurate throughout; the handbook, role playbooks, and Q&A drill formats read clean.

Changed

- **The weekday analysis now covers all five editions.** ABCC 2024 ran Feb 21–24 — also a Wednesday start — so the pattern is three Wednesday starts in a row (2024, 2025, 2026), not two, and 2023's Thursday start belongs to the old two-round format. The table in `facts_and_rules.md` now shows all five editions, and the seven documents that cite the pattern were repropagated ("both documented editions" → "all three ABCC-format editions").
- **The compliance card in `role_playbooks.md` listed two of the three file-name conventions** — added "[Team Name] Boardroom Case".
- Verification log restructured with a dated second-pass section; status dates bumped to 2026-08-05.

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v10 — Material and structure improvement round · 2026-08-04

Structure

- **A `README.md` index in every lifecycle folder** (01–08). Each says what the folder holds, in what order to use it, and which hard rules live there. GitHub renders them under the folder's file list, so browsing the repository is now self-guiding. They are navigation; `DOCUMENTATION.md` remains the per-file reference.
- **`05-practice-cases/index.md` merged into that folder's `README.md`** and deleted — the new index made it a near-duplicate. Nothing was lost: the recommended re-crack order, the "other sources" list, and the 2027 client pattern all moved across, and a stale instruction to "create the simulation log on first simulation" (it has existed since v3) is gone.
- **Tables of contents added to the 16 documents over ~1,500 words**, generated from their own headings. In the three practice cases the list deliberately **stops at the coach-only teaching note**, with a line saying so, so a table of contents cannot become a shortcut to the solution.
- **One heading convention across the three practice cases.** They had drifted into three: case 3 marked its teaching note with a plain paragraph and used H2 for part separators, case 2 called its narrative "CASE

NARRATIVE", case 1 "THE CASE". All three now run `# THE CASE` → `# EXHIBITS (CASE DATA)` → `# YOUR TASK` → `# === TEACHING NOTE (coach only) ===`.
- **Repo-wide markdown normalization:** 111 table delimiter rows padded to `| --- | --- |` across 24 files, the one unlanguaged code fence fixed, trailing newlines made uniform. Codified in a new **`.markdownlint.json`** so the editor enforces it from here on.
- **`.gitignore`** now also excludes Office lock files (`~$*`), which appear whenever a `.pptx/.xlsx` is open.
- **The reference convention is now documented** rather than merely observed (`DOCUMENTATION.md` §8): navigation files use clickable relative links, content documents cite root-relative paths in backticks — because the training material gets printed and pasted, where a relative link is meaningless.

Material

- **The 2027 weekday question — researched, resolved as far as it can be, and propagated.** ABCC 2025 ran Wed Feb 19 – Sun Feb 23 and ABCC 2026 ran Wed Feb 18 – Sat Feb 21 (departure Sunday): **both started on a Wednesday.** The published 2027 window, February 18–22, falls **Thursday–Monday** — the first Thursday start in the series. Either the window is exact (registration Thursday, gala Sunday, departure Monday) or the real week is Wed Feb 17 – Sun Feb 21. `facts_and_rules.md` now carries the full analysis with the edition-by-edition table; the handbook's §12 tracker, the calendar footnote, the runbook intro, the travel plan's booking countdown, and both root documents point to it. **Booking consequence, now stated where flights are booked:** the planned envelope (arrive Feb 16/17, return Feb 22/23) covers both readings, so it is safe — but nothing outside it should be booked non-refundably, and hotel nights should not be tied to a round order, until the agenda is published. This replaces the vaguer earlier claim that "the round-to-day mapping must shift somewhere".
- **`frameworks.md` rebuilt as a decision tool.** It was a 540-word list of framework names. It now opens with a **five-minute selector** — a row per case type (A–F, keyed to `case_type_playbook.md`) giving the decision the client faces, the analyses to always do, those usually worth it, and those to skip — and closes with a **"frameworks to handle with care"** table (SWOT, Five Forces, BCG, PESTEL, Ansoff: why judges get impatient, and the one condition under which each earns its slide). The blocks in between gained the judge-facing consequence of each tool rather than just its name.
- **A conflict between two training documents fixed.** `frameworks.md` set a 60-second limit per Q&A answer; `qa_drills.md` — which owns the protocol — sets 20–30 seconds standard and 45 as the maximum for a financial walk-through. `frameworks.md` now defers to it explicitly instead of restating a different number.
- **Briefing for an external judge added** to `judging_scoresheet.md`. The calendar asks for external judges five times (W17, W19, W23–24, both W25 rounds) and there was nothing to hand them: now a recruiting ask short enough to send as-is, and the six points to cover in fifteen minutes — play the client's decision-maker, Implementation & Resources counts 2.5×, question like a practitioner, the clock is hard, feedback as two strengths and two gaps, and the note that a judge who has *not* read the teaching note often gives the more useful verdict.
- **The "Training Series — Part N of 3" labels now say what the series is:** the core skills trio — delivery, defence, numbers — with each part linking to the other two and to the folder index. The label was accurate but unexplained, and three of the six training documents sit outside it.

Closing the open items

- **The briefing deck was updated and rebuilt** — it had gone untouched while the material around it moved, and W1 is the week it gets presented. Two fixes: the schedule frame now carries the weekday finding (both prior editions Wednesday-start; two readings of the 2027 window) instead of a vague "the labels will shift", and the travel checklist said **"arrival by February 18, 2027"** — the day the competition opens, and a day late if the Wednesday reading holds. It now reads "arrive Feb 16 or 17, return Feb 22 or 23". Rebuilt with pdflatex twice; still 25 pages.
- **The registration e-mail now asks the weekday question**, since it is question 1 for the organizers and the answer gates flight booking. It also names what the answer triggers: rewrite the day-sheets, delete the open-question section, book the flights.
- **`.markdownlint.json` contradicted the convention it was meant to encode** — `default: true` enables MD025 (one H1 per file), which would flag the practice cases whose H1 part separators had just been standardized. MD025 is now off, and §8 says why.
- **`preparation_plan.md` corrections:** the planning horizon said ~28 weeks against the calendar's 29; the W20 milestone stated a numeric rubric target (≥80%) that all but collided with the simulation log's W25 target (≥85/105), so it now defers to the log, where the targets live in one place.

- **An overstatement of my own, corrected:** the new external-judge briefing claimed the calendar asks for judges at "W17, W19, W23–24 and both W25 rounds" (five). The log specifies four — W17, W23–24, and both W25 rounds — matching the plan's "at least 4 sessions". W19 is now described as graded and worth a judge if one is available, which is what it is.
- **A reverse cross-reference** from `case_type_playbook.md` to the new selector in `frameworks.md`, so the pair links both ways: classify the case, then read off the analyses it needs.
- **Format-quiz answer 24** now carries the weekday nuance as a bonus point.

Verified

Every quantitative answer key in the repository was recomputed and holds: the 40 business-math drills and their anchor numbers · all four sets in `workbook2_quant_drills.md` · the key calculation in each of the twelve mini-cases, including the derived ones (overtime premium €54 × 0.4/1.4, agency premium €2.8M × 0.65/1.65, renter-first lifetime margin, contribution per bottleneck-hour). **One defect found:** mini-case 7 labelled 1.71M as "summer" revenue when it is the April–October operating season (1.8M less 90k winter), not the 82% landing in July–September — a student computing 1.8 × 0.82 would have got 1.476M and doubted themselves. Relabelled.

Also verified: the 3-hour and 4-hour prep phase clocks match line for line between the role playbooks and the runbook, and each sums exactly to its window · round formats, weights, rubric multipliers and card timings agree wherever restated · the ten simulations match the calendar week for week · 188 in-page anchors resolve, no broken links · no duplicate file content · LaTeX build leaves nothing untracked.

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v9 — One repository · 2026-08-04

- **Archive unzipped into the repository root.** The eight lifecycle folders (`01-competition` … `08-briefing-slides`) and `.gitignore` now sit at the top level. Every path in every document already pointed at this layout, so all cross-references resolve unchanged — verified file by file.
- **Eleven duplicated files removed.** `coach_and_ai_rules.md`, `exercise_catalog.md` (the copy of `04-training/exercises/README.md`), `team_template.pptx`, the six `case-type-templates/*.pptx`, `case_financial_toolkit.xlsx`, and `judge_brief_template.docx` were confirmed byte-identical to their canonical counterparts before deletion. `abcc_overview.pdf` existed in two builds of the same 25-page deck; the newer one was kept at `08-briefing-slides/abcc_overview.pdf`.
- **`asper-abcc-2027.zip` retired** (14 MB). Its content is now the repository; earlier revisions of the zip remain in git history.
- **Archive history preserved.** The nested repository's eight commits (v1–v8) were fetched into the **`archive-history`** branch before its `.git` was discarded — `git log archive-history` still shows the full provenance. Never merged; kept as a reference ref.
- **Root documents de-duplicated against each other.** `README.md` had grown a full per-folder file inventory that duplicated `DOCUMENTATION.md`; it is now the entry point (competition overview, current week, quick start per role, folder-level map, workflow summaries, rubric, rules cheat sheet, timeline, sources) and defers all per-file detail to `DOCUMENTATION.md`. Its two README variants collapsed into one.
- **`DOCUMENTATION.md` restructured** from eleven sections to nine: the two-layer explanation and the workspace↔archive sync procedure are gone; §1 is now a plain repository layout with a short note on the flattening; the verification log became a structural check with a re-runnable cross-reference script.
- **Maintenance rules gained** "one canonical copy per file — link, do not copy", replacing the sync rule.

Archive history (pre-v9, branch `archive-history`)

v8 — Documentation overhaul · 2026-08-04

- **Two-layer model documented.** `DOCUMENTATION.md` now opens by distinguishing the workspace from the archive and states, file by file, which duplicates are byte-identical, which differ by design, and which material exists only in the archive. Previously the file described the eight numbered folders as if they sat next to the reader, which is only true inside the unpacked archive.
- **Inventory re-pathed and re-verified.** Every entry in the file inventory now carries its full archive-relative path instead of a bare filename, and every count in it was checked against the files: 87 flashcards, 40 math drills, 60 Q&A questions in five banks, 25 quiz questions in four blocks, mini-cases 1–12, 8/6/8 exhibits in

the three full cases, 14 slides in the team template, 13/12/11/11/12/12 in the six case-type decks, 21 frames + 4 section pages = 25 pages in the briefing deck, 54 files in total.
- **New: documentation metrics** — 35 markdown files, ≈73,000 words, per-folder word counts, asset sizes, exercise volume.
- **New: sync procedure** (§6) with the exact commands for edit → commit → rebuild zip → refresh workspace duplicates, plus the rule that the archive is the master.
- **New: verification log** (§9) recording what was checked on 2026-08-04, a re-runnable duplicate-integrity script, and an explicit statement of what was *not* re-verified (no official URLs were re-fetched).
- **New: propagation order** (§7) for rules changes — which file to touch after which, ending at the briefing deck, the format quiz answer key, and the READMEs.
- **New: conventions section** (§10) collecting the anonymity, coach-silence, GenAI, and confidentiality rules that were previously scattered.
- **Weekday shift flagged in the top-level documentation.** February 18–22, 2027 falls Thursday–Monday, while the 2025 baseline ran Wednesday–Sunday (registration Wed Feb 19, 2025). The round-to-day mapping is therefore explicitly TBA in `DOCUMENTATION.md` and both READMEs, matching the hedges already present in `02-plan/week_by_week_plan.md` and `07-logistics/competition_day_runbook.md`.
- **Status dating.** Both READMEs and `DOCUMENTATION.md` now state the verification date and the current calendar position (W1, Aug 3–9, 2026) instead of an undated "now".
- **This changelog added**, in both layers.
- Archive `README.md` refreshed: current-week block, corrected next actions, weekday note, pointers to `DOCUMENTATION.md` and this file.
- No content documents were changed: the rule base, handbook, calendar, practice cases, workbooks, templates, and logistics files are untouched at v7 state.

v7 — Consistency pass · 2026-08-04

Repaired text corruption, fixed drill arithmetic, corrected the past-case counts to eleven official cases across ten clients (2023 ran both rounds on Manitoba Hydro), with six PDFs mirrored locally and five linked by URL.

v6 — Exercise program · 2026-08-01

Added ≈200 solved exercises: the 25-question format quiz with answer key, four workbooks anchored in the real ABCC case PDFs (reading and structuring, quant, storyline and slides, delivery), mini-case set 2 (cases 7–12, Canadian-leaning and quant-heavier), and the week-mapped exercise catalog. Added the coach & AI rules one-pager and integrated the exercise layer into the plan and documentation.

v5 — Restructure · 2026-08-01

Reorganized everything into the eight numbered lifecycle folders (`01-competition` … `08-briefing-slides`), rewrote all cross-references, added `DOCUMENTATION.md`, and reduced the archive `README.md` to a lean front page.

v4 — Templates and toolkit · 2026-08-01

Added the six case-type slide skeletons (A–F) and the case-type playbook, the financial toolkit (`.xlsx` with live formulas), the judge-brief template (`.docx`), the competition-day runbook, the vocabulary flashcards, the registration e-mail draft, and the team charter.

v3 — Adversarial review · 2026-08-01

Fixed 36 findings from a multi-agent adversarial review, validated every official URL, and added the mini-case pack (cases 1–6), the role playbooks with the GenAI standard operating procedure, the model answers, the English phrasebook, the judging scoresheet, the simulation log, and the anonymity-proof team `.pptx` template.

v2 — Validation and expansion · 2026-08-01

Added the validated handbook, the past-case dossier with six mirrored official PDFs, three original full practice cases, the training pack, and the dated week-by-week plan. Updated the briefing deck and the fact base to the official ABCC 2025 Event Guide rules and rubric.

v1 — Initial commit · 2026-07-31

The ABCC 2027 briefing deck, the preparation plan, and first resources.

Workspace history (pre-v9, on `main`)

2026-08-04 — Documentation overhaul

Rewrote `DOCUMENTATION.md`, substantially updated `README.md`, added this changelog, and rebuilt `asper-abcc-2027.zip` from the archive at v8. Corrected the README's claim that the loose files are byte-identical to their archive counterparts: `README.md` is a different document by design, and the archive holds the newer build of `abcc_overview.pdf` — everything else was verified identical.

2026-08-04 — Documentation and resource update

Expanded practice cases, exercise catalog, and the team-anonymity clarification (fictional consulting name chosen by the team, division letter A–I drawn on site); zip refreshed.

2026-08-01 — Workspace README

Added the long-form workspace entry point.

2026-08-01 — Initial import

Imported the workspace contents: documentation, briefing PDF, slide templates, toolkit, judge brief, coach and AI rules, exercise catalog, and the archive zip.